

stealing from Apple's OS, a precedent could be set whereby large organisations could get away with stealing core concepts of a programmer's work. Apple eventually lost all its claims in the lawsuit and was denied a re-appeal to the US Supreme Court in 1994.

Chipsets Enter The Picture

A group of integrated circuits designed to work together is called a chipset. These are normally used to expand the capabilities of the computer and are attached to the motherboard. Before the first chipsets were introduced, the motherboard had dozens of peripheral chips that performed different functions like displaying video, processing video etc. With the advent of chipsets, these functions were increasingly performed by one entity on the board.

Chips and Technologies was the first manufacturer of chipsets. Its first product was an EGA IBM-compatible graphics chip that allowed the earliest IBM PCs to have VGA video capabilities. It also designed a microprocessor for the 386-compatible computers, which were never really popular. Chipsets from companies such as Trend Microsystems and Western Digital were more popular at the time.

The company was acquired by Intel in 1997 for its core business of chip design. Today the chipset market is dominated by audio and graphics chips makers.